

CALIMESA FIRE DEPARTMENT

POLICY MANUAL

VOLUME 6

Policy: 600.24 Rehab

11/2023

Page 2 of 6

- B. There may be the need for multiple REHAB Units or Areas on an incident, The REHAB area shall be names for its geographical location.
- C. A Work/Rest crew rotation cycle will be implemented by the IC or designee based on the incident or training exercise needs.

COMMUNICATION:

- A. The REHAB group Supervisor will utilize the designated tactical frequency.
- B. Whenever a firefighter requires transportation for injury or illness from the REHAB Group to a hospital for further evaluation and treatment, it is the responsibility of the REHAB Group Supervisor to notify the IC or designee.
- C. REHAB may be established at any type of incident. If a firefighter requires transport for injury or illness for further evaluation and treatment from the REHAB Group during a Mass Casualty Incident (MCI) it shall be the responsibility of the REHAB Group Supervisor to ensure that MEDCOM is notified to provide the appropriate destination and transport priority.

CONSIDERATIONS:

- A. After a period of intense work, with or without wearing an SCBA, personnel will consider Informal and/or Formal-REHAB. With consideration to the following:
 - a. NWCG/OSHA Heat Index Guidelines (**Appendix A**)
 - b. IC or their designees should be aware of the cumulative effects of previous incidents and potential of future incidents on the firefighters assigned.

FORMS OF REHAB:

- A. Informal-REHAB
 - a. Informal-REHAB is the process of firefighters cooling, resting, and hydrating outside the constraints of a Formal-REHAB area. In many cases, Informal-REHAB will be the only REHAB activities performed at incidents.
 - b. Informal-REHAB can have a designated location or occur at the most advantageous location to accomplish incident objectives.
 - c. Informal-REHAB can include, but is not limited to, on-scene shade, in-cab AC, apparatus ice chests, and cool towels.
 - d. Following Informal-REHAB, Company Officers will evaluate their crew for their ability to return to work, or the need to further REHAB.
 - e. Crews and Supervisors shall adhere to the Department Policy (Section # 301.17) and N.W.C.G. Heat Illness Prevention Plan.

CALIMESA FIRE DEPARTMENT

POLICY MANUAL

VOLUME 6

Policy: 600.24 Rehab

11/2023

Page 3 of 6

B. Formal-REHAB

a. A designated REHAB Area(s), that has been established with an entry/exit point, resource tracking, medical monitoring, recovery area, and documentation.

b. REHAB Group Location:

1. Often co-located with Incident Support/Breathing Support/Medical Unit.
2. Consider utilizing a bus, (School, RTA, etc.) for a large number of personnel requiring rehab in high or low ambient temperatures.
3. Smoke & exhaust free environment.
4. Sheltered from environment (shaded or enclosed) for the liability to cool down or warm-up
5. Large enough to accommodate crews and REHAB personnel.
6. Away from intrusive press and scene operations; close enough to avoid additional fatigue.

c. It shall be the responsibility of the REHAB Group supervisor to notify the IC when Formal-REHAB Areas have been established.

d. It shall be the responsibility of the IC to notify the ECC and all units on-scene that Formal-REHAB has been established. Once determined Formal-REHAB is needed, an ALS ambulance will be requested to assist with REHAB and standby. A REHAB CACHE will also be requested to the incident though the City/ECC, etc.

e. Work/Rest crew rotation will be utilized by the IC/Supervisor.

f. Where Formal-REHAB areas have established, but geography limits their use, consider the following:

1. Adjust work intensity, take frequent recovery breaks.
2. Rotate crews into Formal-REHAB when possible.

g. Adhere to NWCG/OSHA Heat Illness Prevention Plan.

REHAB PROCESS:

A. When Formal-REHAB is used, the REHAB area will be staffed with sufficient personnel as dictated by the Incident Commander and must include sufficient (AMR) ALS personnel.